

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in an online magazine:

DEATH OF FACEBOOK

Since Facebook's launch in 2006, it has become THE number one platform for sharing photos, chatting and sharing much more. Its founder, Mark Zuckerberg, is now one of the richest men in the world. Today there are over a billion registered users of Facebook.

Storm clouds may be on the horizon for Facebook though. Many young people are less interested in using Facebook than older generations. Large numbers of young people see Facebook as being something that is 'uncool' and used by older people. As a result, there is a growing trend for the younger generation to use other social media platforms such as Snapchat, a photo sharing app.

Security is also causing concerns for Facebook. Criminals and terrorists have been using Facebook and large amounts of 'fake news' in recent months have led to increasing criticism. In particular, Russia has been accused of using Facebook to try to influence election results in a number of countries.

But for Hongkongers the biggest worry now seems to be privacy. A recent report indicated that companies are increasingly checking job applicants' Facebook profiles before interviews to find out more about them and also what they really do in their free time. Some companies regularly check what their staff post on Facebook and a number of cases of staff being fired because of comments they posted have been reported.

As the young switch to other platforms and privacy issues grow, more questions are being asked about Facebook's long term success.

You are doing a project on social media. Your group has been asked to discuss Facebook and the future of social media. You may want to talk about:

- whether young people in Hong Kong use Facebook
- what advice you would give people about using Facebook
- whether social media will continue to be popular
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you use Facebook?
2. What do most people like to do on Facebook?
3. What social media do you enjoy using the most?
4. Should schools teach students how to use social media effectively?
5. Why might social media make people feel lonely?
6. How do you know what you read on social media is true?
7. How do you think social media will change in the future?
8. Why do people create fake Facebook pages?